

Dr. Vyshali Manivannan
Dyson College of Arts and Sciences, English, Writing, and Cultural Studies Dept.,
Assistant Professor 2025

Impact Factor

Introduction: A Critique of Citation-Based Metrics

Summary of Citation Report

Evidence of Social Impact

Citation Report

Introduction: A Critique of Citation-Based Metrics

Tenure and promotion are “heavily imbalanced in favor of research—a certain number of publications in problematically determined ‘top’ or ‘excellent’ journals or university presses is considered a ‘threshold’ for advancing toward or attaining tenure.”¹ The use of citation-based metrics to quantify impact has several flaws: prolific output and quality are not necessarily equivalent; journal impact factor does not always reflect the quality of individual articles; the h-index can be inflated by self-citation; and citation-based metrics illuminate a narrow band of impact—typically published, closed-access journal articles, ignoring equally influential forms of citation like calls for papers (CFPs) and conference presentations.² This perception of impact ignores the reach and influence of creative activity and transgenre scholarship as well as the pedagogical impact of such work, given that both creative and scholarly genres are taught in university curricula. Furthermore, citation-based metrics ignore the fact that scholars who are BIPOC, LGBTQIA+, women, disabled, and/or members of multiply marginalized communities are under-cited and underrepresented in many disciplinary canons.³ Given the rise of nontraditional research outputs, citation-based metrics have become even more inadequate for capturing the diffusion and true value of scholarship. Aligning with the spirit of inclusivity that informs my creative and scholarly activity, teaching, and service, I choose to publish in refereed

¹ Agate, N., Long, C. P., Russell, B., Kennison, R., Weber, P., Sacchi, S., Rhody, J., & Thornton Dill, B. (2022). Walking the talk: Toward a values-aligned academy [White paper]. HuMetricsHSS.

² Blaise, C. & Sugimoto, C. R. (Eds.). (2015). Scholarly metrics under the microscope: From citation analysis to academic auditing. *Information Today*.

³ Itchuaqiyag, C. & Frith, J. (2022). Citational practices as a site of resistance and radical pedagogy: Positioning the multiply marginalized and underrepresented (MMU) scholar database as an infrastructural intervention. *Communication Design Quarterly*, 10(3).

open access (OA) journals—freely available to institutional, field-specific, and public stakeholders—and share public scholarship on social platforms to refrain from academic gatekeeping and engage in collaborative, inclusive knowledge-building across disciplines and communities.

These forums often lack unique identifiers (like DOI or ISBN) but possess, in many cases, greater impact in terms of quality, reach, and audience diversity. Even citation-based metrics that include alternative metrics (altmetrics) fail to fully capture this increasingly diverse impact data, as they still discount journals, blogs, and social media networks without unique identifiers embedded in metadata. Thus, the attached citation report does not mention that the introduction to “Carework and Writing During COVID: Part I” has 185 posts, 146 reactions, 15 comments, 24 shares, and 2 referrals on Facebook; “Maybe she can be a feminist and still claim her own opinions?” has 171 reads on Academia.edu; and a Twitter thread of links to my creative-critical scholarship has received 5,909 impressions and 210 engagements, which is significant since Twitter remains a space where writers, researchers, and readers across disciplines actively discuss research and source scholarship for pedagogical purposes.⁴ On social platforms, writing studies professionals have attested to the impact of my research on their scholarship, pedagogy, and writing program administration, sharing images of conference presentation slides and calls for papers citing my work, sharing links to conference talk transcripts posted to my website, and observing that they assign my work in undergraduate and graduate courses and would recommend that others do the same.

In practice, “scholarship that produces objects other than articles and books, interdisciplinary scholarship that falls between disciplinary expectations, [...] engagement with colleagues through peer review and collaboration, and the emotional and intellectual labor of mentorship are all either left out of evaluation processes entirely or considered ‘extra credit’ work.”⁵ The citation report that is summarized and attached below analyzes traditional bibliometrics and altmetrics for projects with unique identifiers. It does not tally bibliometrics and social impact associated with several of my transgenre and creative projects that lack unique identifiers, book chapters, conference activity, and digital advocacy and other public writing that doubles as instruction, service, and/or mentorship.

⁴ Van Noorden, R. (2014). Online collaboration: Scientists and the social network. *Nature*, 512(7513).

⁵ Agate et al. (2022) suggest that scholarly citations are not the most informative measurement of academic impact or success, instead recommending flexible disciplinary expectations and “sharing knowledge, expanding opportunity, and mentoring/stewardship” as high-impact achievements that begin to dismantle the siloed categories of teaching, research, and service.

Summary of Citation Report

Even by normalized citation-based metrics, my creative and scholarly activity has had demonstrable impact. The citation report spreadsheet attached at the end of this appendix is sourced from the following databases: Google Scholar (including data from the Publish or Perish resource), the Scimago website (which ranks journals based on Elsevier's Scopus database), CiteScore (an Elsevier product that draws from Scopus), Ulrich's (database of periodical information), and Altmetrics (complementary, nontraditional bibliometrics). My overall impact is as follows:

- 13 journals in which I have published have 16,207 citations on 2,011 papers between 2020-25. Several are in the top quartiles in their respective disciplines:
 - *Digital Health* is in the second quartile in Computer Science Applications, Health Informatics, Health Information Management, and Health Policy according to Scimago Quartile Rankings; 16th among Medical Informatics journals according to Google Scholar Metrics; and has an above-average impact score of 3.7 and a very high h-index of 52 according to Publish or Perish
 - *Fourth Genre* has a 2.61% acceptance rate according to Duotrope
 - *Paris Review* has a 0.22% acceptance rate according to Duotrope
 - *Platform: Journal of Media and Communication* is in the second quartile in Cultural Studies according to Scimago Quartile Rankings
 - *Forum for World Literature Studies* is in the first quartile in Cultural Studies and in Literature and Literary Theory and is among the top 16% in Literature and Literary Theory according to CiteScore

According to Google Scholar Metrics, Publish or Perish, and Altmetrics, my individual publications are ranked as follows:

- “First, an opening: ‘What counts’ as academic writing and disrupting academic norms (Editors’ introduction to ‘Carework and Writing During COVID: Part I’)” (2022) has been cited 3 times
- “The successful text is not always the one that murders me to protect you” (2022) has been cited 3 times
- “Chaos itself is an order” (2021) has been downloaded 28 times according to the journal website and has an Altmetric score of 3, which is above-average compared to scholarly works of the same age

- “Building a twenty-first-century feminist ethos: Three dialogues for WPAs” (2019) has been cited 4 times
- “‘Maybe she can be a feminist and still claim her own opinions?’: The story of an accidental counter-troll” (2019) has been cited 3 times
- “The author draws a blank: Negotiating academia with/in fibro fog” (2018) has been cited 3 times
- “What we see when we digitize pain: The risk of valorizing image-based representations of fibromyalgia over body and bodily experience” (2017) has been cited 8 times and downloaded 2,118 times according to the journal website and has an Altmetric score of 4, which places it in the top 39% of all scholarly works of the same age
- “‘A way of life that is not entirely unfortunate’: The peripheral cunning of chronic pain” (2017) has been cited 9 times
- “‘Never give ’em what they expect’: The Joker ethos as the zeitgeist of contemporary digital subcultural transgression” (2015) has been cited 3 times
- “Tits or GTFO: The logics of misogyny on 4chan’s Random - /b/” (2014) has been cited 87 times
- “When ‘trolling’ becomes an umbrella term” (2014) an op-ed for *The New York Times*, has been cited 3 times
- “Attaining the ninth square: Cybertextuality, gamification, and institutional memory on 4chan” (2012) has been cited 29 times
- “Interplay amidst the strangeness and the charm: Under-language and the attenuation of meaning in the film adaptation of *Watchmen*” (2011) has been cited 11 times

Even when institutions publicly extol the merits of interdisciplinary, transgenre, community-engaged, participatory, and/or public scholarship, academia’s disciplinary structure—including how we measure impact for tenure and promotion—continues to present barriers to advancing this work. Universities are likely to relegate this work to undervalued categories like service, nonrefereed publications, or presentations. Contrary to these prevailing misconceptions, OA journals are selective, refereed, and high-quality, and many influential OA writing studies journals—like *Kairos*—have robust systems of peer review and acceptance rates of 10-30%. Though the attached report does not explicitly identify or value it, my work has had citational impact in doctoral dissertations, unpublished conference presentations, popular publications, CFPs, roundtable discussions, and other webtexts, as well as pedagogical impact, as it is assigned in undergraduate and graduate courses across disciplines, indicating that my

scholarship is considered important to medical rhetoric, cultural rhetoric, creative-critical methodology, and equity in writing studies program design and administration.

Evidence of Social Impact

To underscore the scholarly legitimacy and impact of social interaction, I have included evidence of public exchanges and direct messages (with permission) that exemplify this below, in reverse chronological order.

Fig. 1: Facebook post about “perimortem” from Dr. Chad Duffy, a disability rhetoric and digital media scholar, quoting the game’s cold open before observing: “Textured with the experimentation of hypertext and choose-your-own adventure books, Vy Manivannan’s /perimortem/ is something I’ve been waiting a long time for. I can’t wait to share it with my students!”



Fig. 2: Tweet from Dr. Chad Duffy: “We played and discussed /perimortem/ in my intro to English studies class (English 201) last spring!”



Fig. 3: Bluesky post from rhetorician Dr. Rebecca Ottman about a presentation I participated in at C&W 2025: “Still thinking about the incredible Narrating Generative AI Refusal panel I watched at #cwcon25 yesterday. Like wow. What an awesome group of scholars doing such critical work in the social and material consequences of AI use.”

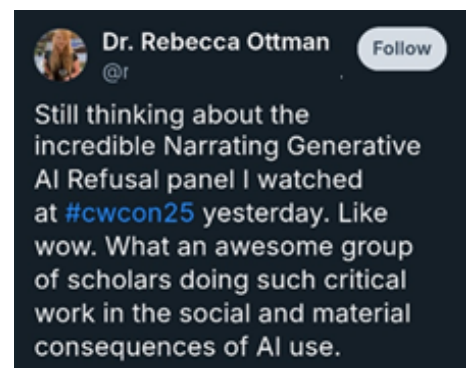
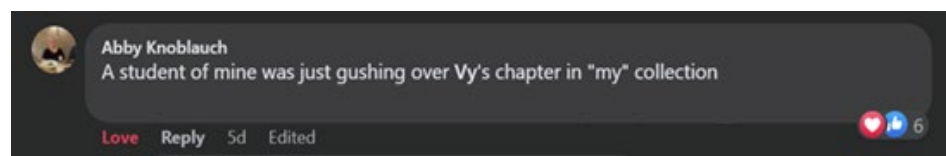


Fig. 4: Facebook comment with five likes (in addition to mine) by Dr. Abby Knoblauch, rhetorician and coeditor of the book in which “The successful text” was published:



Knoblauch, rhetorician and coeditor of the book in which “The successful text” was published:

“A student of mine was just gushing over Vy’s chapter in my collection,” implying the article was an assigned reading.

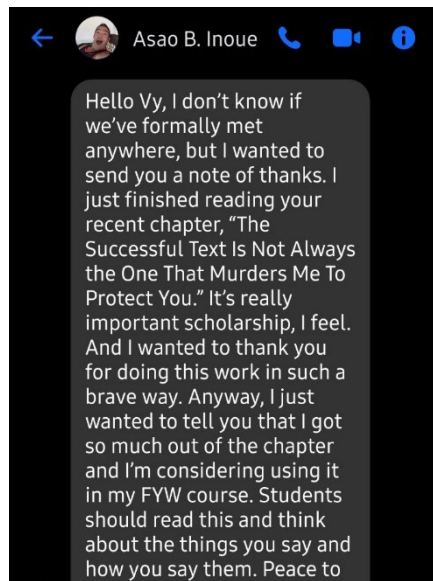


Fig. 5: Facebook message from Dr. Asao Inoue, a rhetorician known for his work on labor-based grading, describing the pedagogical importance of “The successful text”: “I just finished reading your recent chapter, ‘The Successful Text Is Not Always the One That Murders Me to Protect You.’ It’s really important scholarship, I feel. And I wanted to thank you for doing this work in such a brave way. Anyway, I just wanted to tell you that I got so much out of the chapter and I’m considering using it in my FYW course. Students should read this and think about the things you say and how you say them.”



Fig. 6: Facebook post with 17 likes (in addition to mine) from rhetorician Dr. Michelle LaFrance, with comments from Dr. Abby Knoblauch and rhetorician and disability studies scholar Psyche Z Ready, coeditor of *Anti-Ableist Composition* (under review): “Vy Manivannan’s ‘THE SUCCESSFUL TEXT IS NOT ALWAYS THE ONE THAT MURDERS ME TO PROTECT YOU.’ Absolutely devastating brilliance,” with comments reading “Right? I LOVE that essay!” and “Love it so much!”

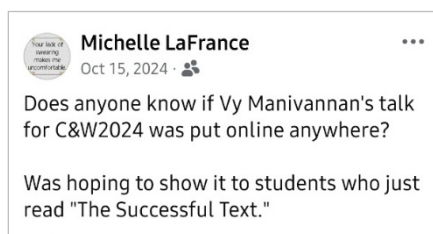


Fig. 7: Facebook query from Dr. Michelle LaFrance: “Does anyone know if Vy Manivannan’s talk for C&W 2024 was put online anywhere? Was hoping to show it to students who just read ‘The Successful Text,’” indicating that both were discussed in class.

As an aside, I've taught "Hollow me, hollow me, until only you remain" every semester since it's been out, and it's a hit with graduate and undergraduate students alike. It's inspired final projects in both my grad seminar (where they used a similar interactive web platform) and in my undergrad Disability Rhetorics class (where a student is designing a board game).

Sending love and spoons,
Jo

Vox Jo Hsu (They/Them)

Fig. 8: Email from Dr. V. Jo Hsu, a respected cultural rhetorician and disability studies scholar, who regularly assigns two of my articles in class: "I've taught 'Hollow me, hollow me, until only you remain' every semester since it's been out, and it's a hit with graduate and undergraduate students alike."

Fig. 9: Syllabi from two classes taught by Dr. V. Jo Hsu that feature "Hollow me" and "A way of life" on the reading list.

Week 8 - Pain	
Tues March 8 [FAC 9]	
Due	
-	Manivannan, "A Way of Life that is Not Entirely Unfortunate": The Peripheral Cunning of Chronic Pain" https://platformimc.files.wordpress.com/2017/08/manivannan-august-2017.pdf
-	Price, "The Bodymind Problem and the Possibilities of Pain" (PDF on Canvas)
-	READING RESPONSE
-	Pod B's Topic Brief from Week 7
-	In Class: Jo intros [applied theory assignment]
Thurs March 10 [Jo is at CCCC]	
[Group time for applied theory assignment]	
Due	
-	Participation Self-assessment 1

Monday, April 17, 2023 | Cultural Rhetorics & Text

- Arellano, Sonia "Sexual Violences Traveling to El Norte: An Example of Guitting as Method"
- Manivannan, Vyshali, "Hollow Me, Hollow Me, Until Only You Remain" <https://sparkactivism.com/hollow-me/>
- Carson, A.D. I Used to Love to Dream
 - <https://www.fulcrum.org/concern/monographs/m900nw52n>
 - Interview with A.D. Carson <https://www.ppihs.org/gn-hip-hop-teaching-and-social-justice-on-interview-with-a-d-carson/>
- Principles in Cultural Rhetorics Scholarship <https://constell8cr.com/conversations/cultural-rhetorics-scholarship/>

Monday posting: Group 1
Wednesday posting: Group 2
Friday posting: Group 3

Fig. 10: Twitter message from digital rhetorician Dr. Cara Marta Messina, pointing to her pedagogical use of "Hollow me": "I taught your Spark game 'Hollow Me, Hollow Me' to my introduction to Game Studies Course! They learned about the platform and loved how you used the game mechanics to share your experience."





Fig. 11: Twitter message from an anonymized disability studies scholar, describing personal impacts and pedagogical uses of “Hollow me”: “I came across Hollow Me when it was published in Spark Activism and have been sending it to everyone I can since. I cried when I played the game, it’s just so similar to my own experiences... I’m teaching an upcoming course on Feminist Disability Studies for Arts 130 at Univ. of Waterloo and I’ve slated this brilliant game for one of the weeks! I’m also referencing it in my dissertation in a chapter that looks at the hystericizing of fibromyalgia patients from a collection of rheumatology articles in the early 2000s.”



Fig. 12: Tweet from disability studies scholar Dr. sarah currie: “your pedagogy inspires mine! [...] i’ve showed my class ‘hollow me hollow me’ minigame~”

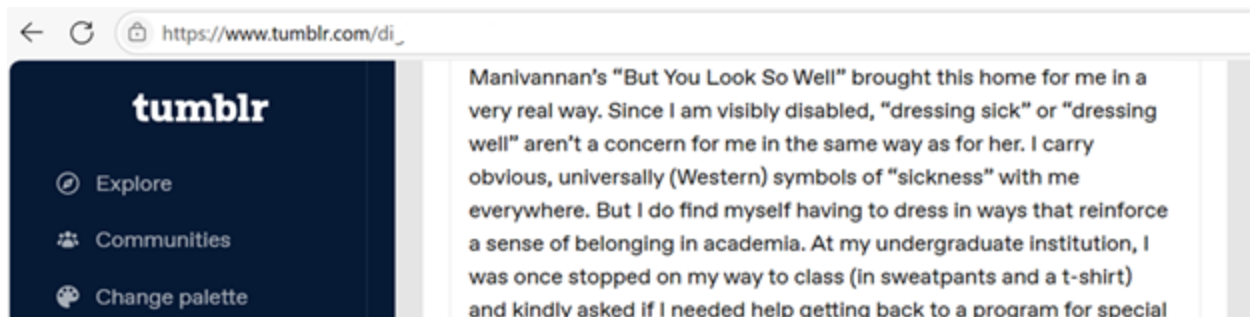


Fig. 13: Tumblr post by an anonymous student for a course, indicating that “But you look so well!” was assigned in the course: “Manivannan’s ‘But You Look So Well’ brought this home for me in a very real way.”



Fig. 14: Tweet by Dr. Gin Schwartz regarding the use of my public writing in the classroom: “I share your writing in grad classes at SF State University. Students (future/current teachers themselves) really vibe with this:

[“The Syllabus I Can’t Give You”].”



Fig. 15: Facebook comment by respected cultural studies, disability studies, and digital rhetoric scholar Dr. Christina Cedillo: “I’ve assigned “But You Look So Well!”

Fig. 16: An Instagram message by digital rhetorician Dr. Elkie Burnside, gesturing at how their research, teaching, service, and administrative work has been influenced by the body of my work: “Since first encountering your work during a panel at C&W 2017 I have been following and learning more about accessible instructional practices. In particular the special issue of JOMR that you co-edited help me give voice to and process the place of personal experience in academic spaces & acknowledging that personal/professional blend that occurred even more specifically during early COVID.”

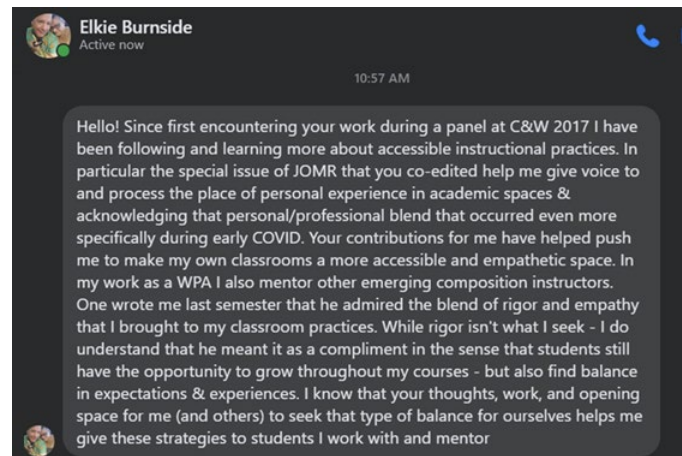


Fig. 17: “Your writing about anti-ableist pedagogy continues to influence my policies, our program policies, and my own thinking about what equitable classrooms look like.”

As additional evidence of impact, videos of my creative-critical media or performances uploaded to YouTube demonstrate engagement: “Doctoral presentation: “This is about the body, the mind, the clinic, the academy, time, and pain”” was viewed 59 times; “The author draws a blank” was viewed 131 times; and “The author is in pain” was viewed 117 times. Furthermore, several of my publications are listed in lists are designed to mitigate token citation and broker alliances across the discipline: the [Multiply Marginalized and Underrepresented](#) (MMU) Scholar Database—a regularly updated, public bibliography of work by MMU writing studies scholars—and on the [Disability Rhetoric Resources](#) page.

Name of Journal	Refereed/ Peer Reviewed Source: Ulrich's Directory	Journal Impact Factor Source: Journal Website	Citation Years Source: Publish or Perish	Papers Source: Publish or Perish	Citations Source: Publish or Perish	Journal h-index Source: Publish or Perish	Journal ISSN & its publication dates	Scimago Quartile Ranking Source: Scimagojr.com	Scopus CiteScore Source: scopus.com/sources	Scopus CiteScore Journal Rank Source: scopus.com/sources	h5-index Source: Google Scholar Metrics
Peitho	Yes	N/A	2020-2025	55	175	6	2169-0774; Pub dates: 1996-present	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Kairos	Yes	N/A	2020-2025	7	6	1	1521-2300/1544-1733 (eISSN); Pub dates: 1996-present	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Spark: A 4C4Equality Journal	Yes (journal website)	N/A	2020-2025	8	35	5	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Fourth Genre	No	N/A	2020-2025	256	12	2	1522-3868/1544-1733 (eISSN); Pub dates: 1999-present	Quartile 4 in Language and Literary Theory	0	2% (ranked 1055 of 1106 Literature and Literary Theory journals)	2
The Paris Review	No	N/A	2020-2025	350	31	3	0031-2037; Pub dates: 1953-present	Quartile 4 in Language and Literary Theory	0	2% (ranked 1055 of 1106 Literature and Literary Theory journals)	2
Journal of Multimodal Rhetorics	Yes (journal website)	N/A	2020-2025	3	0	0	2472-7318, Pub dates: 2017-present	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
WPA: Writing Program Administration	No	N/A	2020-2025	111	308	9	0196-4682; pub dates 1977-present	N/A	N/A	N/A	7
Platform: Journal of Media and Communication	Yes	N/A	2020-2025	11	23	3	1836-5132, pub dates: 2009-present	Quartile 3 in Communication; Quartile 2 in Cultural Studies	0.5	51% (ranked 624 of 1304 Cultural Studies journals)	N/A
Digital Health	Yes	3.7 (5-year)	2020-2025	1000	15,374	52	2055-2076, pub dates: 2014-present	Quartile 2 in Computer Science Applications; Quartile 2 in Health Informatics; Quartile 2 in Health Information Management; Quartile 2 in Health Policy	2.9	49% (ranked 156 of 270 Health Policy journals)	46 (ranks 16th of Medical Informatics journals)
Fibreculture Journal	Yes	N/A	2020-2025	74	191	9	1449-1443 (ISSN), pub dates: 2003-2019	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Enculturation	Yes	N/A	2020-2025	1	0	0	1525-3120; pub dates 1997-present	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
ImageTexT: Interdisciplinary Comic Studies	Yes	N/A	2020-2025	17	17	2	1549-6732; pub dates 2004-present	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Forum for World Literature Studies	Yes (journal website)	N/A	2020-2025	118	35	3	1949-8519/2154-6711(eISSN); pub dates 2009-present	Quartile 1 in Cultural Studies; Quartile 1 in Literature and Literary Theory	0.6	84% (ranked 165 of 1106 Literature and Literary Theory journals)	5
ARTICLE LEVEL METRICS											
Name of Article	Citations Source: Publish or Perish	Article views/ downloads	Altmetric score								
"Pain and Relief Come of Themselves," <i>Peitho</i>	0	N/A	N/A								
"perimortem [in (theoretical) rigor]," <i>Kairos: A Journal of Rhetoric, Technology, and Pedagogy</i>	0	N/A	N/A								
"Hollow Me, Hollow Me, Until Only You Remain," <i>Spark: A 4C4Equality Journal</i>	0	N/A	N/A								
"Chaos Itself Is an Order," <i>Fourth Genre</i>	0	28	3								
"Easter in Sri Lanka: Today Is Loss That Isn't Loss," <i>The Paris Review</i>	0	N/A	N/A								
"'But You Look So Well!': (Un)professionalizing Chronic Pain through Academic Dress," <i>Journal of Multimodal Rhetorics</i>	0	N/A	N/A								

[illegible]

